

VERNON AND DISTRICT ASSOCIATION FOR COMMUNITY LIVING

ETHICAL CODE OF CONDUCT

Vernon and District Association for Community Living's Ethical Code of Conduct establishes the ethical, social, and environmental values that guide professional conduct and ethical decision-making. It provides a framework to ensure respect, dignity, safety, and inclusion for all participants, employees, volunteers, and community partners.

All staff, volunteers, and students must sign this document, confirming they have read, understood, and will adhere to VDACL's Ethical Code of Conduct.

DEFINITIONS:

Community Living British Columbia (CLBC) - The provincial authority supporting community living programs.

Vernon and District Association for Community Living – hereinafter referred to as “VDACL”

Ethics: Principles guiding moral conduct, duties, and obligations.

Social Media: Platforms for creating, sharing, or participating in online content or networks.

SCOPE: Applies to all employees, students, and volunteers at VDACL.

Ethical Code – Dignity and Respect

- 1) Treat all individuals with dignity, respect, and fairness, regardless of disability, gender identity, age, race, religion, sexual orientation, ethnicity, marital status, socio-economic status, or political affiliation.
- 2) Services are person-centered, addressing social, physical, spiritual, and psychological needs.
- 3) Promote an inclusive and accessible environment, ensuring communication and services accommodate all participants' needs.

Ethical Code – Confidentiality

- 1) All participant, employee, and Association information is confidential and may not be shared without authorization from VDACL Management, except as required by law.
- 2) Staff must follow policies on privacy, data protection, and social media.

Ethical Code – Safeguarding and Safety

- 1) Protect participants from abuse, neglect, exploitation, and harassment.

- 2) Suspected abuse, neglect, or exploitation of participants must be reported immediately, in accordance with provincial legislation and VDACL policy.
- 3) Follow all health, safety, and infection control standards.

Ethical Code - Service Delivery and Support Practices

- 1) Uphold participants' rights and person-centered philosophy in all services.
- 2) Encourage and respect participant input in all plans and programs.
- 3) Provide an enriching environment that supports participant growth and goals.
- 4) Identify and eliminate barriers (attitudinal, architectural, communication) to participation.
- 5) No exchange of gifts, money, or gratuities with participants without Management approval.
- 6) No personal fundraising on behalf of participants.
- 7) Treat property and personal belongings of the Association, participants, staff, and visitors with respect and care.
- 8) Maintain professional boundaries and perform only duties within the scope of the role.
- 9) Unauthorized personnel must not witness legal documents or conduct financial transactions on behalf of participants.

Ethical Code –Professional Responsibilities

- 1) Uphold all laws, policies, and ethical standards.
- 2) Avoid conflicts of interest and disclose any potential conflicts.
- 3) Promote a welcoming and positive workplace, free from harassment, bullying, or retaliation.
- 4) Advocate for participants while maintaining ethical standards.
- 5) Create and maintain a climate of care, trust and mutual respect.
- 6) Contribute to VDACL's professional aims in a manner that upholds organizational integrity and public trust.
- 7) Foster a culture in which best practice is pursued in all activities.
- 8) Consider the public perception of personal and professional actions and their effect on VDACL's reputation.
- 9) Accurately present qualifications, skills, abilities, expertise and limitations.
- 10) Respect resources and personal property of participants, employees, visitors, and the Association.
- 11) Maintain professional growth through education, training, and self-care.
- 12) Ensure social media posts positively reflect VDACL while maintaining privacy and confidentiality.

Ethical Code – Financial and Business Practices

- 1) Conduct all financial and business practices in accordance with laws, bylaws, policies, and generally accepted accounting practices.

- 2) Conduct business relationships in compliance with CLBC, legal, and Association standards.
- 3) Apply non-discriminatory practices in employment, compensation, assignment of work, and promotions.

Ethical Code – Marketing and Public Representation

- 1) Marketing activities must be truthful, accurate, and respect participant dignity and privacy, and will highlight the mission, goals, and accomplishments of VDACL while upholding the integrity of the Association and maintaining public trust and support.
- 2) Public actions and social media posts should positively reflect VDACL and maintain confidentiality.
- 3) Marketing activities will not mislead or misinform the public or misrepresent the Association.

Reporting Violations of Ethical Code of Conduct

- 1) Employees and volunteers must report suspected violations promptly.
- 2) Reports will be handled confidentially and without reprisal.
- 3) Executive Management will review all reported violations and conduct investigations within reasonable and transparent timelines to ensure fairness and thoroughness.
- 4) Failure to comply may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

Resolution of Ethical Dilemmas

- a) Identify the ethical conflict and relevant values
- b) Identify stakeholders and possible impacts
- c) Weigh benefits and risks of possible decisions or actions
- d) Consult stakeholders and seek consensus on an appropriate course of action
- e) Implement decisions and document the process
- f) Evaluate outcomes and lessons learned

Acknowledgement

I have read, understood, and will uphold VDACL's Ethical Code of Conduct and confirm that in performing my duties, I will act:

- (a) truthfully, faithfully, and to the best of my ability.
- (b) in the best interest of all participants.
- (c) courteously, professionally, and ethically.
- (d) in accordance with confidentiality rules and Association policies.

Name: _____ Signature: _____

Date: _____ Witness: _____